

"You do not choose the wolf. You bleed, and it decides you're ready."



THE UNBROKEN

A WEREWOLF CLASS FOR AVARA

Base Class · Beast's Instinct · Four Tank Packs

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☾ A WEREWOLF CLASS FOR AVARA

I. LORE — THE BATHORY PACK AND WHAT CAME BEFORE IT

Long before Vaela ever stood as proof that wolf and vampire could share one body, the packs of Avara were already old. Where a Sangreal is made — turned, chosen, given the Progenitor's fractured blood on purpose — **the Unbroken are made by nothing so deliberate.** A wolf is not sired. A wolf is *revealed*, usually at the worst possible moment: a blade that should have killed you, a wound that should have ended the fight, and instead of dying you simply — changed.

This is why the class has no elegant origin myth the way the Sangreal's Progenitor does. There is no first wolf whose blood split five ways. There is only the fact, repeated across centuries and bloodlines that have nothing to do with each other: **enough pain, in the right person, reveals something that was always underneath.** The packs that formed afterward — Ironback, Bloodfang, Warden's Circle, and the stranger, newer lineage tracing back to Vaela herself — didn't organize around shared blood. They organized around *shared answers to the same violence.*

The Bathory Pack, Aalise's own circle of bound wolves, sits at the center of most of what's documented about the Unbroken in Avara — not because they invented the condition, but because they were the first to survive it long enough to write anything down. Vaela's own line is the newest and strangest of the four fully catalogued here: proof that the wolf's revelation and the vampire's turning aren't as incompatible as either side likes to claim.

A fifth answer is rumored — older packs speak of wolves who never needed the wound at all, who simply chose the change and paid for it a different way. Nothing about that lineage has been confirmed enough to write down yet.

☾ QUICK GLOSSARY

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Waking Form	Your baseline. Not weak — just not yet what you become.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Bloodlust	Your resource. Builds from damage dealt or taken while transformed (and banked, at a reduced trickle, even before).
The Threshold	Dropping to half HP or below transforms you into Beast-Form automatically, free.
Beast-Form	What you become. Lasts up to 10 minutes — you don't flicker in and out between fights in the same encounter window.
Challenge DC	8 + proficiency bonus + Strength modifier. What creatures save against for Howl of Provocation.
Compulsion DC (<i>Vaela's Line only</i>)	8 + proficiency bonus + Charisma modifier.

II. CLASS BASICS

- **Hit Die:** d12
 - **Primary Ability:** Strength, Constitution
 - **Saving Throws:** Strength, Constitution
 - **Armor:** Light armor, medium armor, shields
 - **Skills:** Choose 2 — Athletics, Intimidation, Perception, Survival, Animal Handling, Insight
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III. BLOODLUST — THE WHOLE SYSTEM

"The pack doesn't ask if you're hurt. They ask if you're still standing. Those are different questions, and only one of them matters."

Waking Form. Your starting state — normal stats, no tank kit active. Taking damage here still matters: **Simmering Blood** (Level 2) banks the full amount as Bloodlust, waiting for the moment you'll actually need it.

The Threshold. The instant you drop to half your max HP or below, you transform into **Beast-Form** — automatically, free, no action spent, no choice required. Whatever Bloodlust you banked in Waking Form is already there.

Beast-Form. Lasts up to 10 minutes; ends only by your own choice or by being knocked unconscious. **While transformed, dealing or taking damage generates Bloodlust equal to the full amount, either direction** — no discount for pain, no bonus for violence, symmetric on purpose. **Whenever you'd take damage, you may spend Bloodlust to reduce it, 1-for-1, with no action required** — you declare the spend the instant the damage would land.

One rule threaded through everything built on this class: nothing here ever heals you directly. The pack keeps you standing — your own hands don't. (Level 3's Fed by the Pack makes that principle count for more, not less: it rewards *their* healing, never grants you any of your own.)

IV. CLASS FEATURES BY LEVEL

☾ LEVEL 1 — BEAST TRAITS, WAKING FORM, BLOODLUST, THE THRESHOLD, BEAST-FORM

Darkvision 60 ft.; advantage on Perception and Survival checks relying on smell or hearing. See Section III for everything else — this is the entire system, and it doesn't get more complicated than what's written there.

☾ LEVEL 2 — BEAST'S INSTINCT, SIMMERING BLOOD, BARED FANGS

Choose your first **Instinct** from Section V — a lever that shapes how tanky you actually are. You'll pick again at 7, 9, and 17, and may swap a known Instinct for a different one whenever you take an ASI.

Simmering Blood: while in Waking Form, taking damage generates Bloodlust equal to the full amount taken, banked until you transform. You may also spend banked Bloodlust to reduce damage you take while still in Waking Form, at a cost of **2 Bloodlust per 1 point of damage reduced** — worse than the 1-for-1 rate you get once transformed, which is what makes holding for the Threshold a real bet instead of a foregone conclusion.

Bared Fangs (reaction, Waking Form only, usable a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest): when an ally within 10 ft. of you is about to be hit by an attack, you may interpose a warning snarl — the attack is made with disadvantage. This is the wolf's instinct to protect its pack showing up before the change fully takes it — reactive and single-target, a permanently different job from Howl of Provocation's proactive area taunt, so it never goes obsolete once you have both.

☾ LEVEL 3 — TANK PACK, WIDENED FRAME, FED BY THE PACK

Choose your Pack. Grants a feature now (including its own reshaping of what Beast-Form does) and again at 8, 11, 15, and 18. Also unlocks a pool of Pack-exclusive Instincts, available at any future Instinct pick.

Widened Frame: the first time you transform into Beast-Form during an encounter, roll a number of d4s equal to your class level and add your Constitution modifier — your hit point maximum increases by that total, and you immediately regain that many hit points. This lasts until Beast-Form ends. Stacks with any Pack feature that further increases your HP maximum while transformed (Ironback's own bonus sits on top of this, not instead of it).

Fed by the Pack: while in Beast-Form, any healing you receive from an ally, object, or effect restores the maximum possible amount instead of being rolled. Still not a source of self-healing — this only ever fires off someone else's action, but when it does, it's never wasted.

☾ LEVEL 4 — ASI

☾ LEVEL 5 — EXTRA ATTACK

☾ LEVEL 6 — HOWL OF PROVOCATION

Bonus action, spend 3 Bloodlust: every enemy within 15 ft. that can hear you must succeed a save against your Challenge DC or, on its next turn, use its movement to approach you by the safest available path and make a melee attack against you if able — no choice in the matter on a failed save.

☾ LEVEL 7 — BEAST'S INSTINCT

Choose another Instinct.

☾ LEVEL 8 — TANK PACK

Your second Pack feature.

☾ LEVEL 9 — BEAST'S INSTINCT

Choose another Instinct.

☾ LEVEL 10 — PROVOKE THE CHANGE

Bonus action, once per short rest: spend health to drop to exactly 50% of your HP maximum. This immediately triggers the Threshold. Because you chose it, you gain Bloodlust equal to double the HP you

just spent, and your weapon attacks deal an extra 1d8 damage for the rest of this Beast-Form. (Has no effect if you're already at or below half your HP maximum — you'd already be transformed.)

☾ LEVEL 11 — TANK PACK

Your third Pack feature.

☾ LEVEL 12 — ASI

☾ LEVEL 13 — GREATER HOWL

Howl of Provocation's forced attack now also has disadvantage, and any creature that fails the save is weakened until the start of your next turn — its melee weapon attacks deal half damage.

☾ LEVEL 14 — HARDENED HIDE

When you spend Bloodlust to reduce incoming damage, each point spent now reduces the damage by 2 instead of 1.

☾ LEVEL 15 — TANK PACK

Your fourth Pack feature.

☾ LEVEL 16 — ASI

☾ LEVEL 17 — BEAST'S INSTINCT

Choose your final Instinct.

☾ LEVEL 18 — TANK PACK CAPSTONE

☾ LEVEL 19 — ASI

☾ LEVEL 20 — THE UNBROKEN PACK (CAPSTONE)

Once per long rest, when an ally within 30 ft. would be reduced to 0 HP, you may redirect that damage to yourself instead. Reduce the redirected damage using your Bloodlust as normal (including bonuses like Hardened Hide's 2-for-1 exchange). You never heal — but you can always be the one who bleeds instead of them.

V. BEAST'S INSTINCT

Not spells. Not invocations borrowed from something that reads books. Instincts sharpened the only way this class ever learns anything — by surviving something that should have taught it to run instead.

Picked at levels 2, 7, 9, and 17. Swap a known Instinct for a different one any time you take an ASI (4, 12, 16, 19).

- **Thick Hide** — +2 AC while in Beast-Form. (Strong enough that a shield stops being worth the slot.)
- **Iron Constitution** — your HP maximum increases by 1 × your class level while transformed.
- **Adaptive Hide** — each time you enter Beast-Form, choose one damage type: resistance to it until you next transform.
- **Guarding Growl** — Howl of Provocation also grants you and allies in its radius +2 AC until the start of your next turn.
- **Warding Howl** — creatures that fail their save against Howl of Provocation also have disadvantage on the next saving throw they make before the end of your next turn.
- **Packmind** — spend 1 Bloodlust: an ally within 10 ft. rerolls a failed saving throw.
- **Packbound Strength** — while at least one ally is within 10 ft. of you, both you and that ally have advantage on Strength checks and Strength saving throws.
- **Thicker Blood** — Bloodlust generated from damage you take increases by 50% (round up).
- **Second Skin** — once per short rest, when you're about to take damage in Beast-Form, gain temporary hit points equal to your class level before the damage lands. (A one-time buffer, not a restoration — it doesn't refresh until you rest.)
- **Unshakable** — advantage on saves against being frightened or charmed while in Beast-Form.
- **Steady Bond** — gain Bloodlust equal to any healing an ally gives you. You still can't heal yourself — this just means the pack keeping you up directly fuels your ability to keep protecting them.
- **Relentless** — once per long rest, damage that would drop you to 0 HP instead drops you to 1.

☾ PACK-EXCLUSIVE INSTINCTS

Unlocked once you've chosen that Pack at level 3. Drawn from the same pick levels as the general list.

- **Ironback — Bedrock Stance:** Stone Wall's cap still applies even at 0 Bloodlust.

- **Bloodfang — Vicious Cycle:** whenever Blood for Blood deals damage, gain Bloodlust equal to half that damage.
- **Warden's Circle — Between Us:** while Circling Guard is active, allies it protects also have resistance to damage from any attacker within your reach.
- **Vaela's Line — Borrowed Grace:** once per short rest, when you spend Bloodlust to reduce damage, you may also move up to half your speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

VI. THE TANK PACKS

☾ THE IRONBACK PACK

"The pack watches you take blow after blow and simply not fall. That certainty is worth more to them than any shield."

Pure mitigation. No punishment, no redirect — the wall that doesn't move, and doesn't need to explain why.

Level 3 — Ironback Transformation, Stone Wall, Unyielding Your HP maximum increases by $2 \times$ your class level while transformed, and you have advantage on Strength and Constitution saving throws.

Stone Wall: whenever you'd take damage in Beast-Form, after any Bloodlust you choose to spend normally, if the remaining damage would still exceed **25% of your max HP**, you may automatically spend additional Bloodlust — beyond what you already chose — to bring it down to that threshold. If you don't have enough left to fully close the gap, it reduces the damage as far as your remaining Bloodlust allows.

Unyielding: when you spend Bloodlust to reduce a hit all the way to 0, you generate Bloodlust equal to half the damage that was reduced (rounded down).

Level 8 — Grounded While in Beast-Form, you can't be knocked prone or moved against your will by any effect, and difficult terrain never costs you extra movement.

Level 11 — Absorbing Frame Stone Wall's cap tightens to **20%** of your max HP. Whenever Stone Wall's cap actually triggers, you gain Bloodlust equal to the amount it cut off.

Level 15 — Shared Foundation Stone Wall's cap now also protects any ally within 10 ft. of you, measured against *their* max HP, paid from *your* Bloodlust. *The pack doesn't feel a wound alone; a blow meant to break one of you breaks against all of you instead.*

Level 18 — The Unbreakable (Capstone) Once per long rest, bonus action: for 1 minute, Stone Wall's cap drops to **15%** of max HP and applies automatically, at no Bloodlust cost. *For one minute, you stop being someone they need to protect at all — you're the one fact of the fight nobody can change.*

☾ THE BLOODFANG PACK

"The bite doesn't end when your jaws release. Bloodfang doesn't let a wound close clean — and it doesn't let the enemy forget it drew blood from you first."

Retaliation. Every hit that lands on you is a mistake the attacker keeps paying for.

Level 3 — Bloodfang Transformation, Blood for Blood, Marked by Pain Your claws count as magical weapons for overcoming resistance, and deal an extra 1d6 damage on a hit.

Blood for Blood: whenever you spend Bloodlust to reduce a hit, the attacker takes necrotic damage equal to half the Bloodlust you spent (rounded down).

Marked by Pain: a creature damaged by Blood for Blood has disadvantage on its next saving throw against Howl of Provocation before the end of its next turn.

Level 8 — Festering Wound Blood for Blood's damage becomes a lingering wound: the creature also takes the same amount again at the start of its next turn, unless it receives healing first.

Level 11 — Shared Retribution Blood for Blood now also triggers when an ally within 10 ft. of you takes damage from a melee attack — you spend your own Bloodlust to punish an attacker who never touched you at all.

Level 15 — Feared Reputation Any creature that's taken damage from Blood for Blood this encounter has disadvantage on attack rolls against you specifically, for the rest of the encounter.

Level 18 — The Reckoning (Capstone) Once per long rest, bonus action: for 1 minute, Blood for Blood's damage doubles, and Festering Wound's lingering damage can no longer be prevented by healing — only time ends it. *For one minute, nothing you touch gets to heal from it — not with magic, not with time. That's the promise Bloodfang makes to anything foolish enough to strike first.*

☾ WARDEN'S CIRCLE

"It doesn't matter what you were already doing. The wolf moves anyway."

Redirect. You get between the party and the thing trying to kill them — physically, repeatedly, on your own terms.

Level 3 — Warden's Transformation, Stand Between, Circling Guard Your reach increases by 5 ft. while transformed, and your movement speed is never reduced by difficult terrain when moving toward an ally under attack.

Stand Between (reaction, no Bloodlust cost to activate): when a creature within your movement range attacks an ally, move there — using your actual movement, so anything boosting your speed this turn extends your reach — and become the target of that attack instead. Spend Bloodlust normally to reduce the resulting damage.

Circling Guard: while you have at least 1 Bloodlust, enemies have disadvantage on attack rolls against any ally within 10 ft. of you, unless they target you instead.

Level 8 — Between Blows Stand Between no longer costs your reaction if the attack you're redirecting would have targeted an ally at 0 HP — you can always answer a killing blow, even if you've already used your reaction this round.

Level 11 — Widening Circle Circling Guard's radius extends to 15 ft., and Stand Between's range is no longer limited to your movement — it works at 30 ft.

Level 15 — Unbroken Line When Stand Between triggers, the attacker has disadvantage on its next attack roll, against anyone, before the end of its next turn.

Level 18 — None Shall Pass (Capstone) Once per long rest, bonus action: for 1 minute, Stand Between triggers automatically and for free — no reaction spent — on every attack against an ally in range, and Circling Guard's disadvantage applies even to attacks made against you. *A real risk as well as a promise: without a Pack Instinct or feature backing your durability, this can mean absorbing far more damage in one minute than any other capstone asks of you. That's the trade Warden's Circle makes, with its eyes open.*

☾ VAELA'S LINE

"Becoming Beast-Form here means becoming something closer to what Vaela is — the hybrid made literal, not just borrowed."

The odd sibling. Control and speed pulled from vampire blood, layered over a body that still refuses to heal itself.

Level 3 — Vaela's Transformation, Blood-Quick, Faltering Will You gain the vampire's Vampiric Traits while transformed: darkvision 60 ft. (or +30 ft. if you already have it), resistance to necrotic damage, and you no longer need to breathe.

Blood-Quick (bonus action, spend 1 Bloodlust): your speed doubles until the end of the turn, you don't provoke opportunity attacks, and if you end that movement within 10 ft. of an enemy you weren't already next to, your first attack against it this turn has advantage.

Faltering Will: whenever you spend Bloodlust to reduce a hit, the attacker must succeed a save against your Compulsion DC or its speed becomes 0 until the start of your next turn.

Level 8 — Second Nature Blood-Quick no longer costs Bloodlust — free, once per turn.

Level 11 — Compelled Retreat When Faltering Will's save fails, the creature is also pushed 10 ft. away from you, if there's room.

Level 15 — Blood Eruption When Faltering Will triggers on a creature, every *other* enemy within 10 ft. of that creature must also save against your Compulsion DC or suffer the same speed-zero effect. One failed save at the center of a cluster locks down the whole cluster.

Level 18 — Vaela's Wrath (Capstone) Once per long rest, action: unleash a burst of blood-quickened compulsion in a 30 ft. radius centered on you. Every enemy in range must save against your Compulsion DC or be frightened of you and have its speed reduced to 0 until the end of your next turn. For each creature that fails, you regain 1 Bloodlust.

VII. FEATS

Same discipline as the base kit — every feat here sharpens something that already exists, nothing introduces a parallel system.

⌋ GENERAL FEATS

- **Deep Reserves** (*Full*) — Bloodlust generated from damage dealt or taken while in Beast-Form increases by 50% (round up).
- **Efficient Fury** (*Half, +1 Con*) — once per short rest, any single Bloodlust-cost ability costs nothing.
- **Longer Fangs** (*Half, +1 Str or Con*) — Beast-Form's duration extends to 1 hour instead of 10 minutes.

☾ IRONBACK FEATS

- **Deeper Roots** (*Full*) — Absorbing Frame's Bloodlust refund (when Stone Wall's cap triggers) doubles.
- **Steadfast** (*Half, +1 Con*) — Grounded's immunity to forced movement and prone extends to allies within 5 ft. of you.
- **Foundation's Reach** (*Half, +1 Con*) — Shared Foundation's radius extends from 10 ft. to 20 ft.
- **Endless Bedrock** (*Full*) — Unyielding's refund becomes the full amount reduced, instead of half.

☾ BLOODFANG FEATS

- **Longer Claws** (*Full*) — Blood for Blood's necrotic damage increases from half the Bloodlust spent to the full amount.
- **Infectious Bite** (*Half, +1 Str or Con*) — Festering Wound's lingering damage also applies from your claw attacks' bonus damage, for the same amount as that bonus damage — but still only on a turn where Blood for Blood has already triggered.
- **Spreading Grudge** (*Full*) — Marked by Pain also applies to any other enemy within 5 ft. of the creature you damaged via Blood for Blood.
- **Undying Grudge** (*Half, +1 Str or Con*) — Feared Reputation's disadvantage lasts until the creature dies, instead of just until the encounter ends.

☾ WARDEN'S CIRCLE FEATS

- **Longer Reach** (*Full*) — Stand Between's range no longer depends on your remaining movement — it works at 30 ft. regardless.
- **Watchful Circle** (*Half, +1 Str or Con*) — Circling Guard's radius increases by 5 ft. whenever you have 10 or more Bloodlust banked.
- **Twin Guard** (*Full*) — Stand Between can trigger a second time in the same round; the second use costs 3 Bloodlust instead of your reaction.
- **Between Blows, Echoed** (*Half, +1 Str or Con*) — Between Blows' reaction-free trigger also applies, once per short rest, to an attack that would drop an ally to or below half HP, not just to 0.

☾ VAELA'S LINE FEATS

- **Swift Current** (*Full*) — Blood-Quick can be triggered as a reaction, once per short rest, when an enemy moves within 10 ft. of you.
- **Deeper Compulsion** (*Half, +1 Cha*) — Faltering Will's speed-zero effect also gives the creature disadvantage on attack rolls while it lasts.
- **Widening Eruption** (*Half, +1 Cha*) — Blood Eruption's radius increases to 20 ft.

- **Unshaken Grip** (*Full*) — Compelled Retreat's push also knocks the creature prone if it hits an obstacle or another creature during the push.
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VIII. MAGIC ITEMS

One Rare, one Very Rare, one Legendary — per Pack.

⌋ IRONBACK

- **Rare — Girdle of the Steadfast:** Requires attunement. Grounded's immunity to forced movement explicitly overrides spell effects that normally bypass it (Thunderwave, Repelling Blast, similar).
- **Very Rare — Bracers of the Bedrock:** Requires attunement. Stone Wall's cap applies immediately, before you've chosen to spend any Bloodlust voluntarily.
- **Legendary — The Ironback Mantle** (*Ironback only*): The Unbreakable usable twice per long rest; its cap drops to 10% while active.

⌋ BLOODFANG

- **Rare — Claws of the First Wound:** Requires attunement. Blood for Blood's necrotic damage can instead match your claws' damage type, ignoring resistance to necrotic specifically.
- **Very Rare — Collar of Undying Grudge:** Requires attunement. Feared Reputation's disadvantage extends to every ally attacking that creature, not just you.
- **Legendary — The Reckoning Fang** (*Bloodfang only*): The Reckoning usable twice per long rest; its lingering damage can't be reduced by resistance either, not just prevented by healing.

⌋ WARDEN'S CIRCLE

- **Rare — Boots of the Closing Line:** Requires attunement. Stand Between no longer uses your movement — it's a free teleport within its range.
- **Very Rare — Chain of the Unbroken Line:** Requires attunement. Unbroken Line's disadvantage also applies to the attacker's next saving throw, not just its attack roll.
- **Legendary — The Warden's Aegis** (*Warden's Circle only*): None Shall Pass usable twice per long rest; while active, you have resistance to all damage — the direct answer to that capstone's real risk.

☾ VAELA'S LINE

- **Rare — Anklet of Borrowed Speed:** Requires attunement. Blood-Quick's "ended within 10 ft." clause extends to 15 ft.
 - **Very Rare — Choker of the Faltering Will:** Requires attunement. Your Compulsion DC increases by 1.
 - **Legendary — Vaela's Own Collar** (*Vaela's Line only*): Vaela's Wrath usable twice per long rest; creatures it frightens also have their speed held at 0 for the full duration of the fear, not just until your next turn.
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IX. THE ARTIFACT — THE FIRST WOUND

A relic older than any single Pack. It does not favor one over the others.

- **Levels 1–4:** +1 to attack and damage rolls. Whenever the Threshold triggers you, immediately gain an extra 1d6 Bloodlust.
 - **Levels 5–10:** +2 to attack and damage. Beast-Form's duration extends by another 10 minutes.
 - **Levels 11–16:** +3 to attack and damage. Once per long rest, bonus action: Hardened Hide's 2-for-1 exchange becomes 3-for-1 for 1 minute.
 - **Levels 17–20:** +3 retained. Once per long rest, bonus action: immediately gain Bloodlust equal to your HP maximum — and if you're not already transformed, this triggers the Threshold.
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"Five hungers wear one face across the sea in the old blood. The Unbroken never got that kind of story. Just a wound, and then a wolf, and a pack deciding — every single time — whether that was enough reason to follow."